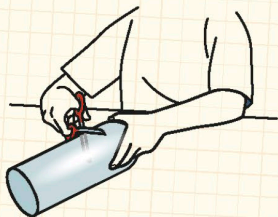


MAKE A RAIN GAUGE

If you want to keep a record of how much rain falls, you can make yourself a simple rain gauge like this. You will need a large plastic soft-drink bottle, scissors, tape, a measuring cup, a heavy flower pot, a notepad, and a pencil.



1. With an adult present, use a pair of scissors to cut the neck off the bottle. Set the neck to one side, but don't throw it away!



2. Use the measuring cup to pour $\frac{1}{2}$ cup (100 ml) of water into the bottle. Mark the level with tape and then pour in more water, marking each $\frac{1}{2}$ cup (100 ml) until it is full.



3. Empty the water out and attach the neck of the bottle upside down to the bottom with tape.



4. Set your gauge outside in a heavy flowerpot (to stop it from blowing over). Every day, or week, if you prefer, make a note of how much water there is in the bottle, using the marks to help you.

Every time you measure the water, you can plot the result on a graph.

